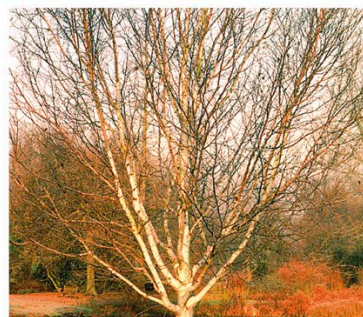




Plants for focal points and topiary

Some plants are natural-born stars, upstaging others with their radiant color, graphic shape, or detailed texture to produce striking features.

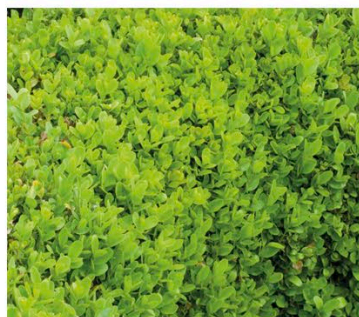
While evergreens provide focal points all year round, deciduous plants often put on a show for just a brief spell and should be planted where they can be seen most clearly at those key times. For example, a cherry tree is best placed where its blossoms will be bathed in spring sunshine, with an undershirt of bulbs to complement the flowery canopy. Unlike focal plants, topiary specimens generally have neither color nor form to set them apart. However, their small insignificant leaves are exactly what's needed to mold them into amazing features guaranteed to draw the crowds.



TREE LARGE

Betula utilis* var. *jacquemontii
HIMALAYAN BIRCH Planted singly as a multistemmed tree or grouped to form a small grove, this white-stemmed birch makes a striking statement. The yellow dangling catkins and yellow fall foliage color are an extra bonus.
↑60ft (18m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-7



SHRUB LARGE

Buxus sempervirens
COMMON BOXWOOD This traditional evergreen hedging and topiary shrub has small, oval glossy leaves. When close-clipped, it will form intricate shapes and green sculptures, such as spirals. Prune between early- and mid- to late summer.
↑↑15ft (5m)

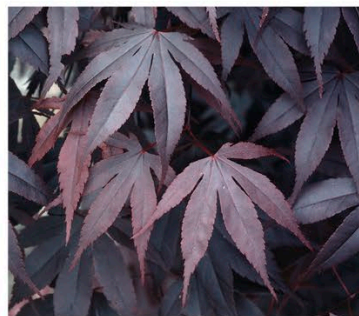
☀️ ☀️ Z6-8



TREE LARGE

Cedrus deodara
DEODAR CEDAR This magnificent cedar needs plenty of space to accommodate its broad spreading canopy of tiered branches covered with short blue-green needles. The shape begins as conical, changing as the tree reaches maturity.
↑130ft (40m) ↔30ft (10m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z6-8



TREE SMALL

***Acer palmatum* 'Bloodgood'**
JAPANESE MAPLE A shapely tree with delicate lobed purple leaves that turn brilliant red in fall, it is especially eye-catching set against evergreens. The skeletal winter framework is also pleasing. Considered invasive in a few areas.
↑↑15ft (5m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5-8



TREE LARGE

Araucaria araucana
MONKEY PUZZLE This large evergreen conifer has a striking branching habit and stems densely clothed in small, scalelike, prickly green leaves. It is slow at first but grows rapidly after a few years, so allow it plenty of space.
↑80ft (25m) ↔30ft (10m)

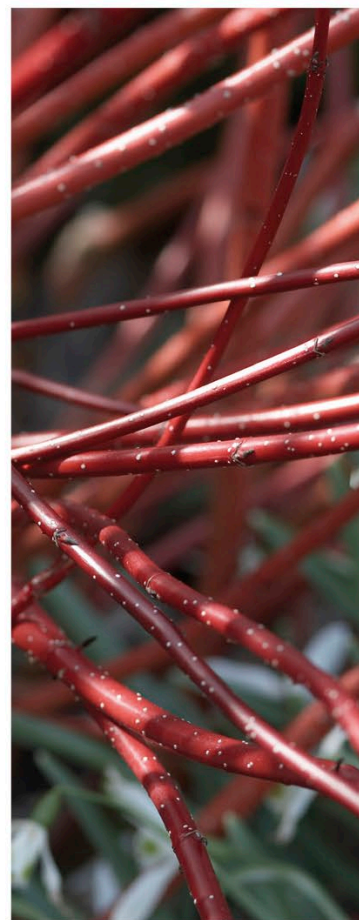
☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z7-11



TREE LARGE

Catalpa speciosa
NORTHERN CATALPA This exotic-looking flowering tree has heart-shaped leaves bearing clusters of white orchidlike late summer blooms with purple and yellow spots on the throats. Long, thin, green-turning-dark brown seedpods follow.
↑↑50ft (15m)

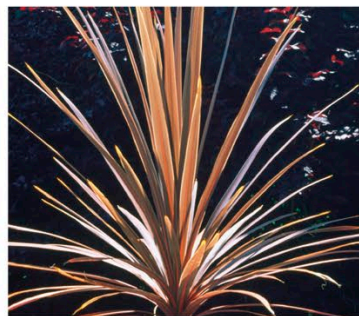
☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-8 (N)



SHRUB LARGE

***Cornus alba* 'Sibirica'**
TATARIAN DOGWOOD This winter interest deciduous shrub is grown for its bright red, strongly upright winter stems, particularly showy when grown in a swath against an evergreen backdrop. Hard prune in late winter for brighter stems.
↑↑10ft (3m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z2-7



TREE SMALL

Cordyline australis
CABBAGE PALM This evergreen accent tree makes a sculptural fountain of sword-shaped leaves, varying from green, through bronze and purple, to variegated. It eventually becomes palmlike. Grow in a tall pot to accommodate taproot; overwinter indoors.
↑10ft (3m) ↔3ft (1m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z10-11